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الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Name .....
Section .....
ID .....

Faculty of Business Studies

BUC111
Business Communication 1

FINAL Examination / Version: B

2024-2025 / Summer

6-Sep-2025

Number of Exam Pages: 6 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 2 hours

Instructions:

1- Take **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
2- Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF**" mode throughout the examination.
3- This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
4- Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches
5- Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the examinatio
6- Students are allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
7- Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

Part	No. of questions	Time	Marks	Earned Marks	Signature
Part I	10	30 minutes	25		
Part II	5	30 minutes	25		
Part III	2	30 minutes	25		
Part IV	1	30 minutes	25		
Total	18	120 minutes	100		

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Part I: Multiple-Choice Section: Choose the most appropriate answer. (25 marks)

1. How should you close a routine request message?
   A) With a clear deadline, contact information, and thanks
   B) By repeating the request several times
   C) With no closing needed
   D) By demanding immediate action
2. What should you include with printed letters asking for recommendations to make it easier for the recipient?
   A) A stamped, addressed envelope
   B) A gift card
   C) A resume
   D) A handwritten note
3. What is the best way to begin a routine positive message?
   A) With a detailed explanation of the background
   B) With the main idea or good news clearly stated
   C) By apologizing for any inconvenience
   D) By asking questions to the reader
4. What should be included in a crisis management plan?
   A) Employee salaries
   B) Future marketing campaigns
   C) Media and social media strategies
   D) Product release schedules
5. What is one reason why application rejections must be written carefully?
   A) To avoid offending the hiring manager
   B) To comply with international labor law
   C) To reduce the risk of discrimination claims
   D) To follow industry fashion
6. Why is praising employees or associates important?
   A) It makes them feel good and encourages further excellence
   B) It allows you to avoid giving constructive feedback
   C) It replaces the need for formal evaluations
   D) It is required by company policy
7. Which of the following is NOT one of the three main categories of persuasive business messages?
   A) Persuasive requests for action
   B) Persuasive expressions of gratitude
   C) Persuasive presentations of ideas
   D) Persuasive claims and requests for adjustment?
8. What does the AIDA model stand for?
   A) Awareness, Interest, Demand, Action
   B) Attention, Interest, Desire, Action
   C) Attention, Information, Decision, Activity
   D) Approach, Intent, Data, Agreement
9. What should you do if your credibility has not already been established with an audience?
   A) Ignore their doubts
   B) Avoid giving any negative news
   C) Use technical jargon to sound professional

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D) Clarify your qualifications

10. Which of the following is an example of reasoning by analogy?
    A) Hiring leadership coaches is like hiring a personal trainer.
    B) If sales went up, it must be because we lowered prices.
    C) Customers are always right, so we must listen to them.
    D) All successful businesses invest in R&D, so we should too.

Part II: Read the sentences below and determine: (25 marks)

- **What type of message is it?** (Routine or Positive / Negative / Persuasive)
- **What specific kind of message is it?** (e.g., Rejection or Refusal, Request for action or information, Performance Review, Claim, Adjustment, Termination, Marketing, Sales, Fostering Goodwill, etc.)

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1. " Sign up today and receive a 20% discount on your first business consultation session."
   a) **What type of message is it?** ----------
   b) **What specific kind of message is it?** ----------

2. "We were saddened to hear about the passing of your colleague, and we send our deepest condolences to your team."
   a) **What type of message is it?** ----------
   b) **What specific kind of message is it?** ----------

3. "We appreciate your interest in our internship program, but we are unable to offer you a position this year."
   a) **What type of message is it?** ----------
   b) **What specific kind of message is it?** ----------

4. "Please forward the Q2 expense reports to the finance department by Friday."
   a) **What type of message is it?** ----------
   b) **What specific kind of message is it?** ----------

5. "Your employment with the company will come to an end on June 30 as part of an organizational restructuring process."
   a) **What type of message is it?** ----------
   b) **What specific kind of message is it?** ----------

Part III: Answer the following questions: (25 marks)

a) Mention **any five types** of effective **buffers** that can be used to soften the opening of a negative message.

1. ----------
2. ----------
3. ----------
4. ----------
5. ----------

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b) What are some of key guidelines for writing clear and effective **instructions**?

1. ----------
2. ----------
3. ----------
4. ----------
5. ----------

Part IV: Evaluating and Crafting Business Messages: Read the case and the email below, then answer the questions that follow. (25 marks)

Background: Sara Al-Mansour, works at BrightTech Solutions, a mid-sized software company. She has been with the company for over three years and has consistently received positive performance reviews. She feels her current salary does not reflect her contributions and wants to request a raise. She is writing a professional email to her manager, Mr. Khalid Al-Jasim, to ask for a salary increase.

Subject: Request for Salary Review

Dear Mr. Al-Jasim,

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to request a meeting to discuss the possibility of a salary review.

Over the past three years at BrightTech Solutions, I have taken on increasing responsibilities, including leading the recent software upgrade project that improved client satisfaction by 15%. I have also consistently met or exceeded my performance goals, as reflected in my annual reviews.

Many of my colleagues in similar roles have recently received salary increases, and I believe my contributions also warrant a review.

Given my commitment and achievements, I would appreciate the opportunity to discuss a possible adjustment to my compensation that better reflects my role and performance.

Please let me know a convenient time for us to meet. Thank you for considering my request, and I look forward to your feedback.

Best regards,
Sara Al-Mansour
Software Project Lead
BrightTech Solutions
+965 5566 7788
www.brighttech.com

Questions:

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1. What elements make the email effective? Justify your answer by giving 3 examples from the email

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2. Identify the logical fallacy in the email. (Name it and write the example from the email.)

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3. Write a **refusal email** in response to the salary increase request above. Follow the criteria for writing effective negative messages (*e.g.,* use a buffer, provide clear reasoning, maintain a respectful tone, and end with goodwill).

To:
Subject Line:

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